



Hegseth’s lawyer at center of media fiat

Legal fixer’s clout in crafting new press pledge fuels unease in Pentagon

BY DAN LAMOTHE

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth’s bid to impose sweeping restrictions on journalists’ ability to report at the Pentagon was orchestrated with advice from his longtime personal lawyer, whose role on Hegseth’s staff has troubled some defense officials.

Tim Parlatore’s dual status as a mid-ranking military officer and legal fixer for Hegseth has attracted scrutiny internally among other officials, some of whom are leery of the influence he wields, people familiar with the matter said. He was integral in shaping the new media restrictions set to take effect this week, according to people familiar with the matter and a draft of the policy obtained by The Washington Post.

The 21-page policy requires credentialed reporters who sign the document to acknowledge they understand Hegseth’s view that by requesting any information — including unclassified material — that has not been preapproved for release by the Pentagon, they are “soliciting or encouraging government employees to break the law.” Such action, the policy claims, “falls outside the scope” of “newsgathering activities” protected by federal law. Journalists who do not sign must leave the building by Wednesday evening.

The Washington Post is among a number of news organizations, spanning the ideological spectrum, that have declined to sign the new rules. Many have cited the proposed changes’ infringement on the media’s First Amendment protections.

Pentagon officials anticipate one or more media outlets may challenge Hegseth’s policy in court, said people familiar with the matter, who like some others spoke on the condition of anonymity to disclose internal conversations.

Parlatore, 46, joined Hegseth’s
SEE PENTAGON ON A8

A change of power in Madagascar



LUIS TATO/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Residents and protesters in Antananarivo, Madagascar, assemble Tuesday after three weeks of massive, youth-led protests sent President Andry Rajoelina into hiding. The military said it had taken control and announced the formation of a transitional government made up of civilians that would rule for two years. **Story, A10**

Trump extols Gaza triumph, sidesteps high hurdles ahead

BY KAREN DEYOUNG

A ceasefire in the two-year Israel-Gaza war, the release of remaining Israeli hostages, and the flow of humanitarian aid into Gaza were welcome first steps in addressing the long-running conflict in the Middle East. Whether they will mark what President Donald Trump on Monday called the “historic dawn of a new Middle East” is another matter entirely.

During a whirlwind, 11-hour victory lap in Israel and Egypt, Trump was rightfully congratulated for spearheading the deal that brought both Hamas and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to heel.

But in speeches, Trump sidestepped any mention of the seismic chasms that remain in the

region — including the West Bank, where about 3 million Palestinians live in an ever-smaller space under increasingly militarized Israeli occupation and threatened annexation.

He predicted the rapid expansion of the Abraham Accords, his first-term achievement of normalization between Israel and a handful of Arab states, but ignored the insistence of much of the rest of the Arab world that the path to a viable sovereign state

SEE GAZA ON A12

Palestinians in U.S.: Hope and doubt color ceasefire reaction. **A12**

Hostages: Whose bodies are set to be returned to Israel? **A13**

Hamas: Trump says U.S. will disarm group if it does not do so itself. **A13**

Pivotal case on voting rights, race returns to high court

BY PATRICK MARLEY AND JUSTIN JOUVENAL

When Press Robinson filed a lawsuit under the landmark Voting Rights Act in 1974, he won a settlement that put him on a path to becoming the first elected Black member of the school board in East Baton Rouge, Louisiana.

The law has been a crucial civil rights tool that has given power to Black and Latino voters and transformed who gets sent to the House, state legislatures, city councils and school boards.

Now, the Supreme Court, which sliced away a large part of the Voting Rights Act a dozen years ago, could eliminate another key provision and reduce minority representation in Congress, reshaping the House in a

way that hasn’t been seen in decades.

At 88, Robinson is again at the center of the fight.

“This is déjà vu. Nothing changes,” Robinson said. “Those people in power want to maintain power among themselves and nobody else.”

The case “could open the door for the first really significant decline in minority representation in more than 100 years in Congress,” said Harvard University law professor Nicholas Stephanopoulos.

Wednesday’s argument at the court lands at a politically volatile moment, as politicians gear up for midterm elections that will determine whether Republicans can retain their fragile control of the House for the second
SEE REDISTRICTING ON A6

6 more killed in strike by U.S.

5TH KNOWN ATTACK SINCE SEPTEMBER

Trump says the men were ‘narcoterrorists’

BY TARA COPP

The U.S. military killed six alleged drug smugglers Tuesday off the coast of Venezuela, President Donald Trump said, the latest development in an ongoing military campaign that has raised questions about his legal authority to use lethal force against vessels suspected of transporting illicit narcotics.

Writing on social media, Trump said that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth had ordered the strike “under my Standing Authorities as Commander-in-Chief.”

Trump claimed the six men killed were “narcoterrorists” affiliated with what he said was a designated terrorist organization, though he did not name it.

The strike hit a vessel in international waters “just off” Venezuela’s coast, Trump said. In a video taken from the air accompanying his social media post, a boat can be seen idling before being hit and bursting into flames.

This is the fifth reported strike by U.S. forces since September against vessels the administration has alleged were carrying drugs. The operations have killed 27 people, the Trump administration has said. It has not disclosed evidence verifying that the vessels were carrying drugs, that the people aboard them were confirmed criminals or which country they came from.

Trump has argued that he has the legal authority to conduct these strikes because he has determined that the United States is in “armed conflict” with Latin American drug cartels.

Some in Congress, which has the sole authority to declare war and has not formally authorized the use of force in this instance, have pushed back against the
SEE STRIKE ON A6

Federal firings target services for the most vulnerable

Most of the jobs cut during the shutdown shared a mission of helping at-risk Americans, officials say

This article is by Hannah Natanson, Laura Meckler, Rachel Siegel, Meryl Kornfield and Amudalat Ajasa

Employees who help regulate hazardous waste. Inspectors who check the quality of federal housing. An office that makes sure students with disabilities get the help they need.

These are among the targets of the Trump administration’s latest round of federal layoffs, undertaken during a government shutdown now entering its third week. Heading into the holiday weekend, the administration dismissed more than 4,000 staffers across seven agencies, and a senior official promised that more job cuts would be on the way soon.

President Donald Trump told reporters in the Oval Office on Friday that he was laying off “people that the Democrats want,” adding that any additional cuts would just deepen pain for the political left.

“It’ll be Democrat-oriented because we figure, you know, they
SEE SHUTDOWN ON A6



MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

With Congress deadlocked, the administration has used the shutdown to lay off over 4,000 workers.

Beijing is playing the ace in its supply-chain strategy

BY CHRISTIAN SHEPHERD AND LYRIC LI

China is wielding its most potent tool of economic coercion — its overwhelming dominance of the rare earths needed to make everything from laptops to jet engines — in an attempt to extract trade concessions from President Donald Trump and ensure the world remains dependent on China for critical raw materials.

Beijing’s dramatic expansion of export restrictions on rare earths Thursday — two weeks before Trump and Chinese leader Xi Jinping are expected to meet — took the White House by surprise. It came, Trump said, “out of the blue.”

But the move was the culmination of a multiyear effort by China to boost its bargaining power by replicating U.S. restrictions on computer chips and other cutting-edge technologies — measures that Beijing sees as constraining its technological advancement and is lobbying for the Trump administration to re-

move.

Rare earths are Beijing’s “trump card,” said Laila Khawaja, an analyst at Gavekal, a research firm based in Hong Kong. Nothing else can make the United States blink, she said.

That’s because China accounts for 70 percent of the world’s rare-earth mining and about 90 percent of the processing of these 17 chemically unique metals.

Beijing this year has significantly expanded its restrictions in response to Trump’s tariffs, culminating in last week’s rules that weaponize its control of global supply.

From Nov. 8, 12 out of 17 rare earths will be subject to export controls, and Beijing will also impose restrictions on lithium batteries used in electric cars and superhard materials used to make mining drills. Licenses are also now required for Chinese companies to sell rare-earth mining and separation machinery abroad.

Perhaps the most significant
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IN THE NEWS

Penalty upheld An appeals court ruled that a Virginia-based bond company must pay \$366 million to migrants it defrauded. **B13**

D’Angelo dies at 51 The R&B visionary and godfather of neo-soul, who mesmerized audiences even as he disappeared from public view for years at a time, had cancer. **B16**

THE NATION
A man pleaded guilty to carrying out an arson attack on the Pennsylvania governor’s mansion. **A2**
The Supreme Court rejected a bid by Alex Jones to set aside a historic jury verdict. **A4**

THE WORLD
President Donald Trump acknowledged that a \$20 billion bailout for Argentina would not primarily serve U.S. interests, testing the patience of American farmers. **A11**

THE ECONOMY
Men are twice as likely to own an electric vehicle, but women and companies are working to close the gender gap. **A14**
The global economy is shrugging off Trump’s tariffs, at least for now, the International Monetary Fund said in its latest forecast. **A15**

STYLE
People protesting an immigration crackdown are getting pumped up — literally — by donning inflatable costumes. **B1**

SPORTS
Caleb Williams enjoyed his Monday night homecoming, which got a boost by his Bears beating the Commanders. **B7**

THE REGION
A former FBI agent convicted of raping three women received a 60-year sentence. **B13**

FOOD
Michelin-starred chefs and food truck operators alike face an uncertain future as Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals recipients. **E1**

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